Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY
Philippine Atmospheric, Geophysical and
Astronomical Services Administration (PAGASA)

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

ENSO ADVISORY

El Niño Advisory No. 1

Recent atmospheric and oceanic indicators show that El Niño conditions are present in the tropical Pacific. In May 2026, the observed relative sea surface temperature anomaly (rSSTA) reached the +0.5°C threshold. Additionally, most climate models suggest there is over an 80% probability that this will develop into a full-blown El Niño event, which is likely to persist until early 2027.

El Niño increases the likelihood of below-normal rainfall conditions, which may result in adverse impacts such as dry spells and droughts in some areas of the country. However, over the western part of the country, above-normal rainfall conditions during the Southwest monsoon season (i.e., *Habagat)* may also occur.

Assessment for May 2026

The weather systems that influenced the country during the period are the easterlies, localized thunderstorms, the Intertropical Convergence Zone (ITCZ), frontal systems, low-pressure areas (LPAs), and the Southwest Monsoon, which began prevailing over the country on May 30. In addition, two (2) tropical cyclones (TCs) entered the Philippine Area of Responsibility (PAR): Tropical Storm (TS) Caloy (HAGUPIT) from 09 to 11 May and Typhoon (TY) Domeng (JANGMI) from May 29 to June 01. Both tropical cyclones remained far from the Philippine landmass and did not directly affect the country. However, TY Domeng enhanced the Southwest Monsoon, resulting in heavy rainfall over the western sections of the country.

The rainfall assessment for the month showed that below-to-way-below-normal rainfall conditions were experienced across Luzon and most parts of Visayas, except in the provinces of Bohol, Eastern Samar, Leyte and Southern Leyte, which received near-normal rainfall. Meanwhile, near- to above-normal rainfall conditions were observed across Mindanao.

Further, based on the said rainfall assessment, nineteen (19) provinces experienced meteorological drought; twenty-nine (29) provinces were under dry spells, and four (4) provinces experienced dry conditions. For a complete list of these provinces, please refer to the Drought/Dry Spell Assessment Maps and Tables.

Slightly warmer to warmer-than-average mean surface air temperatures were observed across most parts of the country during the month, except for select areas in western Luzon, Bicol, and Samar Island where cooler-than-average temperatures were recorded. The recorded temperature ranges were as follows: mountainous areas of Luzon (15.1°C – 27.4°C); rest of Luzon (16.2°C – 41.0°C); Visayas (22.4°C – 37.3°C); mountainous areas of Mindanao (19.4°C – 34.6°C); rest of Mindanao (22.0°C – 36.1°C); and Metro Manila (21.5°C – 37.2°C). Meanwhile, three observation stations established new maximum temperature extremes for May: Tanay, Rizal on May 27 (34.3°C); San Jose, Occidental Mindoro on May 08 (38.7°); and Puerto Princesa, Palawan on May 24 (36.5°C).

Outlook for June 2026

The weather systems expected to affect the country during June are the easterlies, localized thunderstorms, the ITCZ, LPAs, the ridge of the HPA, the Southwest Monsoon, and one (1) to two (2) tropical cyclones (TCs) that may develop within or enter the PAR.

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The rainfall forecast for the month shows that near-normal rainfall conditions will be likely experienced across the country, with higher chances of above-normal rainfall over the western section of Luzon.

Meanwhile, near-average to warmer-than-average mean temperatures are expected across most parts of the country, with isolated areas likely to experience slightly cooler-than-average conditions. The ranges of forecast temperature are as follows: 14.6°C – 28.7°C in the mountainous areas of Luzon, 20.2°C – 40.4°C over the rest of Luzon, 21.0°C – 37.8°C in Visayas, 15.4°C – 33.4°C in the mountainous areas of Mindanao, 20.4°C – 38.3°C over the rest of Mindanao, and 23.1°C – 38.0°C for Metro Manila.

DOST-PAGASA will continue to closely monitor the ongoing El Niño condition and its associated impacts on the country's climate. Meanwhile, all government agencies and the general public are strongly advised to take appropriate preparedness and response measures to mitigate their potential impacts, particularly in areas vulnerable to heavy rainfall and floods during Habagat season and those areas prone to below-normal rainfall conditions.

For more information, please call the Climatology and Agrometeorology Division (CAD) at (02)8284-0800, local 4920 or 4921.

Original Signed:

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Administrator

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